

As for the heart, no one—no one!—could possibly revel in the opportunity to cultivate it more than I, having discovered that diamond of a new heart more than a dozen years ago. And as for character, whatever moral standards I may have developed over my long life, I have tried to invest my own soul and spirit in the character of the little firm that I founded all those years ago.

On a far grander scale than just one human life, these standards of mind, of heart, and of character resonate—as ever, idealistically—in how I hope the leaders of our productive businesses and our financial managers will again seek to manage the trillions of dollars of capital entrusted to their stewardship, putting the will and the work of our business and financial enterprises in the service of others.

## **Returning Stewardship to Capitalism**

My fear—and part of what compels me to continue to press on in my chosen mission of returning capitalism, finance, and fund management to their roots in stewardship—is that in this computer-driven, information-overloaded age, we have forgotten the old truths that so successfully guided us in the past. But while our society's commitment to eighteenth-century values continues to fade, that commitment is hardly nonexistent. I'm heartened by the few—but strong—voices rising to the defense of those values.

For example, listen again to the widely respected businessman Bill George:

*Authentic leaders genuinely desire to serve others through their leadership . . . are more interested in empowering the people they lead to make a difference than they are in power, money, or prestige for themselves . . . are as guided by qualities of the heart, by passion and compassion, as they are by qualities of the mind . . . lead with purpose, meaning, and values . . . build enduring relationships with people . . . are consistent and self-disciplined. When their principles are tested, they refuse to compromise.*